Labeling Guide v3 - Learner States in Replayed Sessions

PRIME Lab -- Labeling guide v3 -- November 14, 2025 -- for raters: David, Minsun, Xiaohang

What changed from v2

• New state: stalled-after-error. Previously these windows were split between tinkering and disengaged.

• Decision rule for the tinkering / stalled boundary (below).

• Context: always watch the 30 seconds before the window.

States

State	Use when
Productive progress	edits that move toward a passing run; new code is kept
Exploratory tinkering	rapid small edits and runs, trying variations, no reverts
Stalled after error	after a failed run: no successful run in the last 3 minutes AND edits are reverted, or idle > 45 s
Assistant help-seeking	writing a prompt or reading an assistant response
Verifying	running tests and inspecting output after a change
Disengaged	idle or off-task without a preceding error

Decision rules

• 1. If the window contains an assistant exchange for more than half of its duration, label help-seeking.

• 2. If there was a failed run in the last 3 minutes, no successful run since, and the student reverts edits or is idle for more than 45 seconds, label stalled-after-error, even if the student is also typing.

• 3. If edits are kept and runs vary, prefer tinkering.

• 4. If a window clearly contains two states, label the one that occupies more time and tick the "mixed" box.

Process

Label in batches of 50 windows. Do not discuss specific windows until the batch is submitted. Calibration rounds: 2 rounds of 40 windows with discussion. Target: all 2,340 windows by Friday, November 21.

Excluded windows

Windows overlapping the section B telemetry gap on November 12 (3:52-4:10 pm) are pre-excluded and will not appear in the queue.